

Reykjavik, Iceland

Climate

Subpolar oceanic and famously changeable. Cool summers around 13 C and, for the latitude, mild but windy winters near 0 C. Near-endless daylight in midsummer, very short days in winter.

Best time to visit

June to August for the midnight sun, hiking and road trips; September to March for a chance at the Northern Lights. Pack for wind and rain in any season.

Top attractions

The Blue Lagoon geothermal spa, the Golden Circle (Thingvellir, Geysir and Gullfoss waterfall), the landmark Hallgrímskirkja church, whale watching, and glacier or volcano tours.

Food

Free-range lamb, fresh cod and langoustine, creamy skyr, dense rye bread, and the local hot dogs (pýlsur). The adventurous can try fermented shark.

Visa & safety

One of the safest countries in the world; the real risks are weather and terrain, so follow your guides on tours. Iceland is in the Schengen Area - check the current entry requirements for your nationality before travel.